Name: Cohort/Batch: Date: Score:

AZURE AKS PRACTICE SHEET - 10 CONCEPTUAL Q&A

10 conceptual Q&A DevOps

TOTAL: 10 QUESTIONS

Q1 What problem does Azure AKS solve in DevOps or infrastructure? Threat Model

Q2 What is Azure AKS's core architecture? Architecture

Q3 How does Azure AKS define infrastructure or configuration as code? Automation

Q4 How does Azure AKS ensure idempotency? Hardening

Q5 How do you handle secrets in Azure AKS? SSO / IdP

Q6 How does Azure AKS integrate with CI/CD pipelines? Observability

Q7 How do you debug a failed Azure AKS deployment? Lifecycle

Q8 What are security best practices for Azure AKS? Compliance

Q9 How does Azure AKS scale for large environments? Testing

Q10 What are common mistakes teams make when adopting Azure AKS? Tuning

ANSWER KEY & EXPLANATORY SOLUTIONS

Comprehensive verified answers, best-practice configs, security controls & reference

VERIFIED SOLUTIONS

A1 **Azure AKS addresses a specific concern** — Mitigation

Azure AKS addresses a specific concern provisioning, configuration management, orchestration, or CI/CD by automating manual steps that are error-prone, slow, or not reproducible when done by hand.

A2 **Azure AKS has a control plane that** — Primitives

Azure AKS has a control plane that stores desired state and a data plane (agents or push-based SSH) that enforces it. Understanding this distinction clarifies where configuration is evaluated and where changes are applied.

A3 **Azure AKS uses declarative files (YAML, HCL,** — Hardening

Azure AKS uses declarative files (YAML, HCL, or a DSL) to express desired state. A plan/diff phase shows what will change before applying. Version-controlling these files enables peer review and rollback.

A4 **Azure AKS operations are designed to produce** — Gotchas

Azure AKS operations are designed to produce the same result when run multiple times. Applying the same config twice converges to the desired state rather than creating duplicate resources. This makes automation safe to re-run.

A5 **Secrets should never be stored in plain** — Federation

Secrets should never be stored in plain text in Azure AKS config files. Use a secrets backend (Vault, AWS Secrets Manager) and inject values at runtime via environment variables or encrypted vaults supported by the tool.

A6 **CI/CD pipelines call Azure AKS in automated** — Observability

CI/CD pipelines call Azure AKS in automated steps: plan on a pull request to preview changes and apply on merge to main. Approval gates can require a human to review the plan before changes go to production.

A7 **Check Azure AKS's logs for the specific** — Automation

Check Azure AKS's logs for the specific error message and the resource that failed. For infrastructure tools, re-run with increased verbosity (-v, --debug). Review the state file or event history to understand what changed before the failure.

A8 **Rotate credentials used by Azure AKS, restrict** — Governance

Rotate credentials used by Azure AKS, restrict network access to its control plane, enable audit logging of all operations, and use least-privilege service accounts. Never run Azure AKS with admin credentials in production.

A9 **Large Azure AKS deployments use workspaces or** — Assessment

Large Azure AKS deployments use workspaces or namespaces to isolate environments, remote state backends for team collaboration, and modular code to avoid a single monolithic config that is slow to plan/apply.

A10 **Common pitfalls include storing secrets in plain** — Optimization

Common pitfalls include storing secrets in plain text config, skipping the plan step before apply, not reviewing state drift, and not having a rollback strategy when a deployment fails partway through.